

products. You can specialise in one aspect or you can have overall coverage of all the domains.

The responsibilities will vary depending on the domain to which the security specialist belongs. Most large organisations have segregation of duties defined so security personnel can focus on those specific domains. In the Security Response domain, AV analysts focus on providing quick mitigation to security threats which are observed in the network. Experts are responsible for providing mitigation to vulnerabilities as they're disclosed and providing mitigation for security risks whose information can be derived from security patches released by vendors.

They get to work on products that secure the email infrastructure or the instant messaging infrastructure of an organisation by keeping out spam, spim and viruses.

"Security domain encompasses many sub areas. At Symantec, there are multiple sub areas of specialisation like anti-fraud protection, anti-spam protection, network intrusion protection, desktop protection, compliance management, data leakage prevention and incident response", informs Shantanu Ghosh.

The most glamorous sub-domain however is ethical hacking or in security parlance – penetration testing. We spoke to penetration testing professional, Siddhesh Shenvi working for AAA Technologies, which specialises in the field of Information Systems (IS) Audit and Security consulting. "We have to sign NDAs (Non Disclosure Agreements) and operate under full authority given by our clients to penetrate and test the vulnerability of their systems," says Siddhesh. He added, "This being the most challenging domain, we're working with the newest technolo-



"Every industry which has data at rest or data in motion needs to have IT Security personnel"

— Shantanu Ghosh, MD, India Product Operations, Symantec Software India Pvt. Ltd.